



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 2

ALABAMA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Alabama's family courts and child-welfare system.

40

ALABAMA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 44
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 2 MONTHS
MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 24, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 67

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ALABAMA AT A GLANCE.

Across 40 Alabama families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 44 40 of 40 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$0 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 2 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 42.5% 25.0% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 40	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.1	REPORTING FAMILIES 40 of 40	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Alabama families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

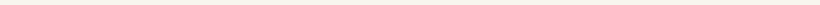
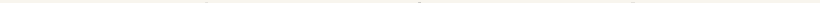
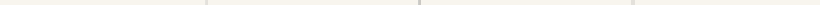
02 THE COST OF ALABAMA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

Expense Category	Responses	Median	Mean	Total Reported
Attorney Fees	40	\$0	\$14,004	\$560,142
Lost Wages	40	\$0	\$180,090	\$7,203,615
Other Court Fees	39	\$0	\$2,090	\$81,500
Therapy / Evaluations	40	\$0	\$1,342	\$53,700
Reunification Services	40	\$0	\$318	\$12,700
GAL Fees	40	\$0	\$829	\$33,150
Asset Loss ¹	40	\$0	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$0	—	—

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$0) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME - MONTHS

Median months lost		2	0.2 yrs
Mean months lost		28	2.3 yrs
Total across all families		1,074	89.5 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ALABAMA

Most families documenting in Alabama are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Currently involved / "S...		16	40%
Unknown		13	32%
Case closed (more tha...		6	15%
Case closed (within th...		4	10%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and ...		16	40%
Family Court Only		11	28%
Unknown		9	22%
CPS (Child Protective ...		3	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		14	35%
5 – 10 years		5	12%
3 – 5 years		5	12%
Over 10 years		5	12%
0-1 years		4	10%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Los...		15	38%
Visitation Only		12	30%
Full Custody		4	10%
50/50 Joint		3	8%
Adopted Out (Rights Te...		2	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Unknown		14	35%
Houston		3	8%
Mobile		2	5%
Autauga		2	5%
Bristol		1	2%
Tuscaloosa		1	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Ac...		9	22%
False Accusations CPS...		7	18%
Other: (Short answer)		7	18%
False Allegations / Co...		5	12%
Medical CPS (Medical ...		3	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — ALABAMA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with [...]

— JACKIE

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

CPS and family court trafficked my children to the pedophile father and erased me, a safe, protective mother from my daughter's lives. I have a gag order and am not allowed to speak about my case. But I still do however I can.

— ALABAMA PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM ALABAMA

Destroyed my family and my relationship with my children who I practically raised on my own for 14 years. Caused trauma, anxiety, PTSD

— BRANDY

Threatening me with jail time unless I gave into the ex at court. All because I would not give my children to him during my parenting time. Simply because the parenting coordinator and GAL said I should. The judge wants to set an example. You cannot bring your phone on that [...]

— RACHEL

The family court system fully showed me why the government should have 0 say so or hand in how YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN ARE parented.

— JESSICA

Destroyed our family my son passed and we have not seen our granddaughter since she didn't even get to come to her dad's funeral

— KELLI

Family court has destroyed all consistency and stability for my children. We do not feel safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A system ment to bring families together did nothing but traumatically rip mine apart.

— FELICIA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The system has proven to my children and I that they are not there to provide support, protection and reunification. They very boldly stand in your face and laugh while doing the complete opposite due to financial motives. They have stolen the first two years of my children's [...]

— MARY

They falsely accused me of child abuse and took two of my children. Then I had another one and they took her. DHR ended up giving me back the youngest and are making me go to family court against my Dad and stepmom for my other two. I just recently went back to court for the [...]

— LATOYA

They took tragedy as an opportunity to create lasting trauma my family and I still have not fully recovered from. We haven't even had a ceremony to grieve our lost son yet because we're still trying to recover from the disaster that destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children have been alienated from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They physically mentally and emotionally abused me and my child and financially took everything from me by my mental stage I have not been able to work since I cannot focus on that when I was focusing trying to figure out why there's taking my child in the first place

— JODIE

Jefferson county has shattered me and left me without a voice all while covering up someone is who abusive and has a criminal record and our children have begged to not go back to him.

— ASHLEE

They've taken children who already lost their parents and put them in dangerous situations when they have a loving grandmother who would give her life to protect and love them.

— STEPHANIE

Left me isolated from every one and mentally debilitated me with phyco report says 60% out of a 100 is my custody n dep issue

— CLOEY

They have ruined my life, making my daughter feel unsafe because we can't be together.

— MEGAN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*ASTNGU. AMTNGU. This bond between us can't be broken, I will be here don't you cry.
You'll be in my Heart. ☐ Always.*

— HEATHER

The court allowed my sister-in-law to walk in there and say I was messed up on drugs leaving my two year old defend for herself. I never got served properly. My neighbor found it in her mailbox, but I still had to hand my children over only two of them, though I got to keep the [...]

— CRYSANY

Took the life of my husband, almost mine and alienated maternal side of the family, unjust actions to terminate my rights. They have taken both of my daughters parents from her.

— HEIDI

Not allowing for me make contact with my daughter, enabling my ex's bad behavior, by allowing her to hide my daughter from me, not telling if she's okay or not, just dead silence

— TERRY

This system has failed my two granddaughters.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Thankfully my family court battle started when my daughter was a baby and her last visit with her father was 2019. But the fear of the Judge and how everything went down was enough to last a lifetime. I hate anyone going through family court. It's so unfair.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son suffers from always worrying about DHR coming to get him. They have tried for 14 years to take my son. I told them they wasn't getting mine and that it was harassment after so many visits. I told them it wasn't a crime to be poor as long as my child had his needs met.

— TRACY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Some days I sit back and realize... the worst thing that has ever happened in my life barely exists in anyone else's. My child was taken away. My world stopped. My heart broke in a way that will never fully heal. But the world didn't stop. People kept laughing. Kept posting. Kept [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined everything I made.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

26 Alabama parents submitted ranked quotes. 26 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/al.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Alabama report comes from Alabama respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Alabama — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 40 Alabama families reporting here are not the universe of Alabama families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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